

SECURITY POLICIES

1. INTRODUCTION

A cybersecurity policy is a set of rules and guidelines established by an organization to protect its computers, networks, applications, and sensitive information from cyber threats.

Security policies help employees understand their responsibilities and ensure that organizational data is accessed, stored, and shared securely. They reduce risks such as unauthorized access, data theft, malware infections, and information leakage.

Every organization, regardless of its size, should have basic cybersecurity policies to maintain a safe digital environment.

2. OBJECTIVE

The main objective of this task is to create a basic cybersecurity policy for a small organization and understand the importance of organizational security controls.

Specific Objectives

- Establish password security rules.
- Define safe device usage practices.
- Protect organizational data and email accounts.
- Prevent unauthorized access.
- Establish incident reporting procedures.
- Promote cybersecurity awareness among employees.

3. BASIC CYBERSECURITY POLICY

3.1 Purpose

The purpose of this policy is to protect the organization's digital assets, confidential information, systems, and networks from cybersecurity threats.

3.2 Scope

This policy applies to all employees, interns, contractors, and authorized users who access the organization's devices, networks, applications, or information.

3.3 Password Security Policy

1. Use strong and unique passwords for every account.
2. Avoid easily guessed passwords such as names, birthdays, or common words.
3. Never share passwords with colleagues or other individuals.

4. Use a password manager to store passwords securely.
5. Enable Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) wherever available.
6. Change passwords immediately if they are suspected to be compromised.

3.4 Device Security Policy

1. Use authorized devices for organizational work.
2. Keep operating systems and applications updated.
3. Enable screen locks and use strong device authentication.
4. Install software only from trusted sources.
5. Use approved security software.
6. Do not connect unknown USB devices to organizational systems.
7. Report lost or stolen devices immediately.

3.5 Email and Internet Security Policy

1. Verify the sender before responding to unexpected emails.
2. Do not click suspicious links or open unexpected attachments.
3. Never share passwords or OTPs through email.
4. Avoid downloading files from untrusted websites.
5. Report suspected phishing emails to the IT or security team.
6. Use official communication channels for organizational information.

3.6 Data Protection Policy

1. Access only the information required for assigned work.
2. Do not share confidential information with unauthorized individuals.
3. Store organizational data only in approved locations.
4. Maintain regular backups of important information.
5. Protect sensitive data when transferring or sharing files.
6. Dispose of confidential information securely.

3.7 Access Control Policy

1. Each employee must use their own account.
2. Access permissions must be assigned according to job responsibilities.
3. Users must not attempt to access unauthorized systems.

4. Unused accounts should be disabled.
5. Access permissions must be reviewed regularly.
6. Employees leaving the organization must have their access revoked promptly.

3.8 Incident Reporting Policy

Employees must immediately report suspected cybersecurity incidents, including:

- Phishing emails
- Malware infections
- Lost or stolen devices
- Unauthorized account access
- Data leakage
- Suspicious system activity

The IT or security team should investigate reported incidents, contain threats, document findings, and take corrective action.

Employees should not hide incidents or delete relevant evidence.

3.9 Employee Responsibilities

Every employee is responsible for:

- Following organizational security policies.
- Protecting passwords and confidential information.
- Completing cybersecurity awareness training.
- Using devices and applications responsibly.
- Reporting suspicious activities promptly.
- Cooperating with security investigations.

4. ORGANIZATIONAL SECURITY CONTROLS

Security controls are measures used to reduce cybersecurity risks.

Security Control	Purpose
Strong Passwords	Prevent unauthorized account access
MFA	Add an extra authentication layer
Firewalls	Control incoming and outgoing network traffic
Antivirus/Endpoint Protection	Detect and help prevent malware
Software Updates	Fix known security vulnerabilities
Data Backups	Support recovery after data loss or ransomware
Access Control	Restrict access to authorized users
Security Awareness Training	Help employees recognize cyber threats
Encryption	Protect data from unauthorized disclosure
Incident Reporting	Enable timely investigation and response

5. IMPORTANCE OF SECURITY POLICIES

Security policies are important because they:

1. Protect confidential and sensitive information.
2. Reduce the risk of cyberattacks.
3. Define employee responsibilities.
4. Prevent unauthorized access.
5. Improve incident response.
6. Support data protection and business continuity.
7. Promote a security-aware workplace.
8. Establish consistent security practices across the organization.

6. EXAMPLE SCENARIO

Scenario: An employee receives an email asking them to download an attachment and enter their company password to prevent account suspension.

Potential Threat: Phishing and credential theft.

Policy to Follow:

- Do not open the suspicious attachment.

- Do not provide the password.
- Verify the request through an official channel.
- Report the email to the IT/security team.

Expected Outcome: The organization can investigate the suspicious email and reduce the risk of unauthorized access.

7. CONCLUSION

Cybersecurity policies are essential for protecting an organization's devices, networks, accounts, and confidential information. A well-defined policy establishes clear rules for password management, device usage, email security, data protection, access control, and incident reporting.

Implementing these policies helps reduce security risks, improve employee awareness, and strengthen organizational security.

A strong cybersecurity policy combines clear rules, appropriate technical controls, employee awareness, and regular review to maintain a secure digital environment.